

FUTURE FORWARD
Delegates at the
inaugural meeting of
Startup20 in Hyderabad



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the Leaders' Summit in New Delhi in September.

The foundation of this success, says Chintan Vaishnav, Mission Director at Atal Innovation Mission (AIM)—an Indian government-led organisation that promotes entrepreneurship and innovation—was built at that first meeting. “Most of the [foreign] delegates who were

not actively in touch with India went away surprised,” Vaishnav tells *Business Today*.

Two features distinguished Startup20, the brainchild of the Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade and AIM, from the start: its sharp focus and its structure. It set out to address some key concerns,

like the fact that a majority of the value created by these ecosystems is concentrated in the top 10 cities globally and the great regional imbalance in access to services as well as capital. To ensure deep discussions on these issues, it set up three task forces—alliances and foundations; finance; and inclusion and sustainability.